Juan-Andrés Castro

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Placement Director: Professor Marco Manacorda
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Fields

Primary: Development Economics, Organizational Economics, Public Economics
Secondary: Technology Adoption, Firm Dynamics, Digital Infrastructure

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Queen Mary University of London — Expected June 2027
Advisors: Pedro Souza and Jonas Hjort
MRes in Economics, Queen Mary University of London — 2023
M.Sc. in Economics, University of Chile — 2018
B.Sc. in Economics, University of Chile — 2016

Fellowships & Awards

ANID Doctoral Scholarship, Government of Chile — 2021
PhD Scholarship, Queen Mary University of London — 2021
COES Scholarship (project quality), Chile — 2017
Best in Business Award & Grunwald Scholarship, University of Chile — 2016
Circle of Excellence (top 5% of cohort), University of Chile — 2013–15

Teaching

Teaching Assistant, Queen Mary University of London
Quantitative Methods using R (×4); Health Economics; Macroeconomics I — 2023–26
Instructor, Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez
Econometrics I (×2) — designed syllabus, lectures, and assessment — 2016–17
Teaching Assistant, University of Chile
Industrial Organization; Econometrics I; Econometrics II; Applied Econometrics — 2013–17

Research Experience

Visiting Researcher, University of Oslo (host: Jonas Hjort) — 2026
Research Assistant, Jonas Hjort, University College London — 2022–25
Research Assistant, Pedro C. L. Souza, Queen Mary University of London — 2022
Research Assistant, Kirill Borusyak, University College London — 2021
Research Assistant, William Mullins, UC San Diego — 2018–19
Research Assistant, V. Paredes, F. Duarte, F. Pino & A. Micco, University of Chile — 2015–18

Employment

Research Analyst, Micro-Finance Research Unit, Central Bank of Chile — 2018–21

Job Market Paper

"Less Paper, More Public Service: Communication Technology inside the State"

Abstract: Public services often leave capacity unused while demand goes unmet. Allocating that capacity requires entities to communicate, often through paper documents. I exploit the staggered, legally mandated rollout of a digital platform that replaced Chile's paper-based system of official communication between state entities. In the National Board of Kindergartens, adoption cuts document processing times by 70%. Documents from the units in charge of enrollment rise, most of them during the enrollment window. Public childcare enrollment rises by 11% over the pre-adoption mean, with no new seats, no change in applications, and no change at providers outside the reform. All of the agency's centers receive the digitized documents, but enrollment rises only in those that also send back their reports and accounts as documents. Three in four of these additional children come from the poorest 60 percent of households. The results show that the technology improved how existing seats were allocated: more children enrolled in the same seats, where enrollment ran through the

channel the technology reached, with personnel, incentives, and authority unchanged. I interpret this as evidence that cheaper communication raises public output where it is part of producing the service.

Papers in Progress

"Data Centers" with Jonas Hjort and Ana Cepeda

"Internet Shutdowns and the Heterogeneous Economic Impact of Connectivity" with Jonas Hjort and Emilio Guaman

Working Papers

"Market Power, Ownership Concentration and Income Inequality" with Alejandro Micco, Andrea Repetto, and Patricio Toro, 2026

"Financial Constraints and Firm Adjustments During a Sales Disruption" with Enzo Cerletti. Central Bank of Chile Working Paper No. 995, 2023

"Telling Schools Apart: The Role of Preferences, Constraints, and the Ability to Differentiate Between Schools in Parents' Choices" with Diego Amador and Nicolás Grau. SSRN Working Paper, 2020

Policy Reports

"Economic Groups as a Unit of Analysis for Financial Stability" with Patricio Toro. Box IV.2, Financial Stability Report, 2019:H2, Central Bank of Chile

"Predictive Models of Default and Recovery of Corporate Loans" with Enzo Cerletti, J. Fernández, and A. Vásquez. Background note, Financial Stability Report, 2019:H2, Central Bank of Chile

Seminars and Conferences

EEA–ESEM Annual Congress, Dublin; SIOE Annual Conference, INSEAD; Queen Mary PhD Economics Conference; Queen Mary Economics Seminar 2026

IWAEE; LACEA Annual Meeting; SECHI Annual Meeting; Queen Mary seminars 2018–25

Software skills

R, Stata/Mata, Python, SQL, MATLAB, QGIS, LaTeX

Languages

Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (fluent)

References

Professor Pedro Souza
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Professor Jonas Hjort
University College London
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Professor Felipe González
King's College London
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Professor Lucie Gadenne
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